
Fwd: Kristel Owen and 1 other sent you messages

Date: Thursday, August 21, 2025 at 7:14:14 PM MDT

From: Shawn Owen <shawn@owenent.com>

To: Shawn Owen <shawn@owenent.com>

Context: DABS POS System Decision Point

This Slack message from **February 5th, 2025** represents the moment when Hills & Hollows had to decide how to handle the upcoming DABS transition (which would take effect July 1, 2025). Tessa had just spoken with **Todd from DABS** about their options.

Message Breakdown

"It would be our preference to use our current POS system, SSCS, for alcohol sales as well as store sales"

What this means:

- Instead of getting a separate new POS system just for alcohol sales, they want to integrate everything into their existing SSCS system
- This would **consolidate operations** instead of running two separate systems
- **Todd confirmed this is acceptable** - DABS doesn't require any specific POS brand

"If we used SSCS, we would only have one register"

Operational significance:

- **Current state:** They had separate Talech register for alcohol + SSCS register for everything else
- **Proposed state:** Single SSCS register for ALL transactions (alcohol + store items)
- **Benefits for staff:** Simpler operations, no switching between systems, reduced training complexity

"Before the DABS got us set up with Talech, all of the alcohol sales were put through our store register and through SSCS so it has been tested"

Historical validation:

- This isn't a new, risky experiment
- **Proven track record:** SSCS successfully handled alcohol sales in the past
- They only switched to Talech when DABS provided it as their standard system
- **Confidence factor:** They know SSCS can handle the technical requirements

"The requirements from the DABS are that whatever POS system we use has sufficient reporting"

DABS compliance requirements:

- Must track monthly and yearly alcohol sales data
- Must provide accurate reporting to DABS for regulatory compliance

- **Key insight:** DABS doesn't care about the POS brand, only the reporting capability

"If all DABS items were in a department together... the reporting will be simple"

Technical solution:

- Create a dedicated "DABS" or "Alcohol" department in SSCS
- This would allow easy separation of alcohol sales from other store sales
- **Reporting benefit:** Clean data extraction for DABS compliance
- **QuickBooks benefit:** Easy integration and separate tracking

"The new way that paying the DABS will work is that they will send us weekly Net 30 Invoices"

Major process change revelation:

- **Old system:** DABS handled all payment processing automatically through Talech
- **New system:** Hills & Hollows receives weekly invoices and must pay DABS directly
- **Payment options:** Manual payment or set up ACH (Automated Clearing House) for automatic payments
- **Cash flow impact:** Net 30 terms mean 30-day payment window

"If we transition this way, I believe it will be the minimal amount of work for the best product"

Strategic analysis:

- Tessa is positioning this as the **most efficient path forward**
- Leveraging existing system knowledge and infrastructure
- Avoiding the complexity of learning an entirely new POS system

"There will be significant work in getting it set up... however this still be significantly less work than starting with a new system"

Implementation reality check:

- **Acknowledges upfront effort:** Getting all liquor inventory into SSCS will be time-consuming
- **Comparative analysis:** Even with setup work, it's less effort than:
 - Learning a completely new POS system
 - Training all staff on new system
 - Managing two separate systems long-term
 - Dealing with integration issues between multiple systems

Strategic Implications of This Decision

What Tessa Got Right:

1. **Operational simplification:** Single system vs. multiple systems
2. **Staff efficiency:** No system switching, reduced training needs
3. **Proven capability:** Historical success with SSCS for alcohol sales
4. **Cost efficiency:** Leveraging existing investment in SSCS

What This Decision Led To:

Based on our earlier research, this decision was implemented, but it created the manual labor challenges we identified because:

- 1. **SSCS lacks direct DABS integration:** Unlike Talech (which was DABS-provided), SSCS requires manual data entry for DABS inventory
- 2. **Invoice processing burden:** The "weekly Net 30 invoices" became the manual invoice entry process we documented
- 3. **Setup complexity:** The "significant work in getting it set up" became the ongoing manual new-item entry process

The Unforeseeable Consequence:

While Tessa's analysis was strategically sound, she couldn't have predicted that DABS would:

- Not provide any automated integration tools
- Require complex manual invoice processing
- Create the monthly price update challenges
- Shift so much administrative burden to the individual stores

This message represents the moment when Hills & Hollows chose operational simplicity over system integration, which was the right strategic choice but led to the manual labor challenges they now face. The solution isn't to reverse this decision, but to **automate the manual processes** that resulted from it.

Kristel Owen and 1 other sent you messages

Date: Thursday, February 13, 2025 at 9:06:09 AM MST
From: Boulder (via Slack) <notification@slack.com>
To: Shawn & notification@slack.com



Boulder
11 members



Your team has sent 15 messages recently

VIEW ALL UNREAD MESSAGES

@Kristel Owen sent a message to the group



Kristel Owen February 11th at 12:07 PM

Dean will you be contacting the division of employment regarding the letter above?

OPEN IN SLACK

@tessakb mentioned you in #hh-admin-managers



Tessa Barkan February 5th at 12:42 PM

@Shawn Owen @Dean LaFleur I spoke to Todd who sent the email about the POS system. It would be our preference to use our current POS system, SSCS, for alcohol sales as well as store sales. Todd says that this is fine and they do not require any specific POS systems. If we used SSCS, we would only have one register and this would actually make things easier for both Heather and I and for staff. Additionally, before the DABS got us set up with Talech, all of the alcohol sales were put through our store register and through SSCS so it has been tested and worked for that purpose.

The requirements from the DABS are that whatever POS system we use has sufficient reporting so that we can track our monthly and yearly sales and provide them accurate information. If all DABS items were in a department together (as they were before), the reporting will be simple, both on the SSCS side and I imagine on Quickbooks too. The new way that paying the DABS will work is that they will send us weekly Net 30 Invoices that we can pay or set up ACH for.

If we transition this way, I believe it will be the minimal amount of work for the best product. We really like the SSCS system and the support that they offer. There will be significant work in getting it set up and making sure all of our liquor store inventory is inputted into SSCS, however this still be significantly less work than starting with a new system and then having to train ourselves and all employees.

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